PERFORMANCE

OnePlus 3

The OnePlus 3 is the unparalleled best performer in the 20-30k segment. OnePlus' combination of closely tuned software and powerful hardware makes it a winner here.

The Snapdragon 820 is Qualcomm's best of the year, and it makes up for all of the 810's faults. You get a score of over 140,000 on AnTuTu, which is second only to the iPhone right now.

It scores over 2000 on 3D Mark's Slingshot test, which is also amongst the highest in the market. It supports the newest APIs and drives the highest frame rates amongst phones today.

4GB out of its 6GB RAM is reserved for multitasking, while the other 2GB comes into play when needed. Currently, this is used for the processing software used in the camera.

Overall, the OnePlus 3 is a dream in terms of performance, for all kinds of users.

LeEco Le Max 2

LeEco's Le Max 2 holds the same hardware as the OnePlus 3. It has 6GB of RAM and the Snapdragon 820 SoC. However, its performance isn't the same, partially because of the heavier eUI.

While the Le Max 2 generates comparable scores on Geekbench's single-core and multi-core tests, it's weak on graphics. It can load apps fast enough, but it doesn't generate frame rates as high as the OnePlus 3.

Of course, the focus lies on video playback, thanks to LeEco's ecosystem-based business model, but in a competitive market, it loses points for performance.

The Max 2 reaches temperatures of over 40 degrees after 10 minutes of 4K video shooting and we recorded 37 degrees after 5 minutes of heavy gaming. This isn't particularly abnormal, but it affects the performance of the phone and can be detrimental in the long run.

Xiaomo Mi 5

While the Xiaomi Mi 5 does have the Snapdragon 820 SoC, it's clocked at 1.8 GHz instead of 2.15 like in the OnePlus 3 and Le Max 2. This results in slightly lower single-core performance, but that shouldn't hinder practical usability matters.

However, while Xiaomi's MiUI is one of the better user interfaces out there, it is still heavier than Oxygen OS. The Mi 5 is slightly weak in graphics tests, although you won't detect this very easily on regular usage. The difference is apparent only when the OnePlus 3 is used side-by-side with the Mi 5.

3GB of RAM is a lot, but more always helps. Running a single heavy game will shut off most other apps.

Where the Mi 5 truly excels is heat management. The only way to truly heat it up is to record 4K video. But it's limited to 7 minutes at most.

ASUS Zenfone 3

The Zenfone 3 is the weakest amongst these four phones. While the Snapdragon 625 is quite power efficient, it pales in comparison to the Snapdragon 820. Qualcomm's quad core Kryo CPU in the Snapdragon 820 is 80% more powerful than the octa-core Cortex A53 CPU on the Zenfone 3. Of course ASUS' bloated and heavy ZenUI doesn't really help its cause in this matter. Rather, ZenUI could use some optimization if ASUS intends to score on the optimization front.

The Zenfone 3 is slower than the other three in all aspects. There is visible lag in graphic intensive activities and apps take quite a while longer to load comparatively. The Zenfone 3's best aspect is in heat and battery management, but we'll get to that later. For now, it's obvious that the Zenfone 3 loses on performance.

Performance (OnePlus 3)

Processor	Snapdragon 820
AnTuTu 6.0	141574
Geekbench 3 Single Core	2361
Geekbench 3 Multi Core	5532
GFXBench Car Chase	1036
3D Mark Slingshot	2431
Gaming performance	5/5

Performance (LeEco Le Max 2)

Processor	Snapdragon 820
AnTuTu 6.0	119979
Geekbench 3 Single Core	2369
Geekbench 3 Multi Core	5516
GFXBench Car Chase	580.9
3D Mark Slingshot	1807
Gaming performance	4/5

Performance (Xiaomi Mi 5)

Processor	Snapdragon 820
AnTuTu 6.0	114215
Geekbench 3 Single Core	1895
Geekbench 3 Multi Core	4650
GFXBench Car Chase	845.6
3D Mark Slingshot	2102
Gaming performance	4.5/5

Performance (ASUS Zenfone 3)

Processor	Snapdragon 625
AnTuTu 6.0	62437
Geekbench 3 Single Core	929
Geekbench 3 Multi Core	5217
GFXBench Car Chase	202.1
3D Mark Slingshot	467
Gaming performance	3/5